

Afflicted Saints.

God is with.

Psalm 46:5. God is in the midst of her; she shall not be moved: God shall help her, and that right early.

Psalm 46:7. The LORD of hosts is with us; the God of Jacob is our refuge. Selah.

God is a refuge and strength to.

Psalm 27:5-6. For in the time of trouble he shall hide me in his pavilion: in the secret of his tabernacle shall he hide me; he shall set me up upon a rock. And now shall mine head be lifted up above mine enemies round about me: therefore will I offer in his tabernacle sacrifices of joy; I will Sing, yea, I will Sing praises unto the LORD.

God comforts.

Isaiah 49:13. Sing, O heavens; and be joyful, O earth; and break forth into Singing, O mountains: for the LORD hath comforted his people, and will have mercy upon his Afflicted.

Jeremiah 31:13. Then shall the virgin rejoice in the dance, both young men and old together: for I will turn their mourning into joy, and will comfort them, and make them rejoice from their sorrow.

Matthew 5:4. Blessed are They That Mourn: for they shall be comforted.

2 Corinthians 1:4. Who comforteth us in all our Tribulation, that we may be able to comfort them which are in any trouble, by the comfort wherewith we ourselves are comforted of God.

2 Corinthians 7:6. Nevertheless God, that comforteth those that are cast down, comforted us by the coming of Titus;

God preserves.

Psalm 34:20. He keepeth all his bones: not one of them is broken.

God delivers.

Psalm 34:4. I sought the LORD, and he heard me, and delivered me from all my fears.

Psalm 34:19. Many are the Afflictions of the Righteous: but the LORD delivereth him out of them all.

Christ is with.

John 14:18. I will not leave you comfortless: I will come to you.

Christ supports.

2 Timothy 4:17. Notwithstanding the Lord stood with me, and strengthened me; that by me the preaching might be fully known, and that all the Gentiles might hear: and I was delivered out of the mouth of the lion.

Hebrews 2:18. For in that he himself hath suffered being tempted, he is able to succour them that are tempted.

Christ comforts.

Isaiah 61:2. To proclaim the acceptable year of the LORD, and the day of Vengeance of our God; to comfort all that mourn;

Matthew 11:28-30. Come unto me, all ye that labour and are heavy laden, and I will give you rest. Take my yoke upon you, and learn of me; for I am meek and lowly in heart: and ye shall find rest unto your souls. For my yoke is easy, and my burden is Light.

Luke 7:13. And when the Lord saw her, he had compassion on her, and said unto her, Weep not.

John 14:1. Let not your heart be troubled: ye believe in God, believe also in me.

John 16:33. These things I have spoken unto you, that in me ye might have peace. In the world ye shall have Tribulation: but be of good cheer; I have overcome the world.

Christ preserves.

Isaiah 63:9. In all their Affliction he was Afflicted, and the angel of his presence saved them: in his love and in his pity he redeemed them; and he bare them, and carried them all the days of old.

Luke 21:18. But there shall not an hair of your head perish.

Christ delivers.

Revelation 3:10. Because thou hast kept the word of my Patience, I also will keep thee from the hour of temptation, which shall come upon all the world, to try them that dwell upon the earth.

Should praise God.

Psalms 13:5. But I have trusted in thy mercy; my heart shall rejoice in thy Salvation.

Psalms 56:8-10. Thou tellest my wanderings: put thou my tears into thy bottle: are they not in thy book? When I cry unto thee, then shall mine enemies turn back: this I know; for God is for me. In God will I praise his word: in the LORD will I praise his word.

Psalms 57:6. They have prepared a net for my steps; my soul is bowed down: they have digged a pit before me, into the midst whereof they are fallen themselves. Selah.

Psalms 71:20-23. Thou, which hast shewed me great and sore troubles, shalt quicken me again, and shalt bring me up again from the depths of the earth. Thou shalt increase my greatness, and comfort me on every side. I will also praise thee with the Psaltery, even thy truth, O my God: unto thee will I Sing with the Harp, O thou Holy One of Israel. My lips shall greatly rejoice when I Sing unto thee; and my soul, which thou hast redeemed.

Should imitate Christ.

Hebrews 12:1-3. Wherefore seeing we also are compassed about with so great a cloud of witnesses, let us lay aside every weight, and the Sin which doth so easily Beset us, and let us run with Patience the race that is set before us, Looking unto Jesus the author and finisher of our Faith; who for the joy that was set before him endured the cross, despising the shame, and is set down at the right hand of the throne of God. For consider him that endured such contradiction of sinners against himself, lest ye be wearied and faint in your minds.

1 Peter 2:21-23. For even hereunto were ye called: because Christ also suffered for us, leaving us an example, that ye should follow his steps: Who did no Sin, neither was guile found in his mouth: Who, when he was reviled, reviled not again; when he suffered, he threatened not; but committed himself to him that judgeth righteously:

Should imitate the Prophets.

James 5:10. Take, my Brethren, the Prophets, who have spoken in the name of the Lord, for an example of suffering Affliction, and of Patience.

Should be Patient.

Luke 21:19. In your Patience possess ye your souls.

Romans 12:12. Rejoicing in hope; Patient in Tribulation; continuing instant in prayer;

2 Thessalonians 1:4. So that we ourselves glory in you in the Churches of God for your Patience and Faith in all your Persecutions and Tribulations that ye endure:

James 1:4. But let Patience have her perfect work, that ye may be perfect and entire, wanting nothing.

1 Peter 2:20. For what glory is it, if, when ye be buffeted for your faults, ye shall take it patiently? but if, when ye do well, and suffer for it, ye take it patiently, this is acceptable with God.

Should be resigned.

1 Samuel 3:18. And Samuel told him every whit, and hid nothing from him. And he said, It is the LORD: let him do what seemeth him good.

2 Kings 20:19. Then said Hezekiah unto Isaiah, Good is the word of the LORD which thou hast spoken. And he said, Is it not good, if peace and truth be in my days?

Job 1:21. And said, Naked came I out of my mother's womb, and naked shall I return thither: the LORD gave, and the LORD hath taken away; blessed be the name of the LORD.

Psalms 39:9. I was dumb, I opened not my mouth; because thou didst it.

Should not despise chastening.

Job 5:17. Behold, happy is the man whom God correcteth: therefore despise not thou the chastening of the Almighty:

Proverbs 3:11. My son, despise not the chastening of the LORD; neither be weary of his correction:

Hebrews 12:5. And ye have forgotten the exhortation which speaketh unto you as unto children, My son, despise not thou the chastening of the Lord, nor faint when thou Art rebuked of him:

Should acknowledge the justice of their chastisements.

Nehemiah 9:33. Howbeit thou Art just in all that is brought upon us; for thou hast done right, but we have done wickedly:

Job 2:10. But he said unto her, Thou speakest as one of the foolish Women speaketh. What? shall we receive good at the hand of God, and shall we not receive evil? In all this did not Job Sin with his lips.

Isaiah 64:5-7. Thou meetest him that rejoiceth and worketh righteousness, those that remember thee in thy ways: behold, thou Art wroth; for we have Sinned: in those is continuance, and we shall be saved. But we are all as an unclean thing, and all our righteousnesses are as filthy rags; and we all do fade as a leaf; and our iniquities, like the wind, have taken us away. And there is none that calleth upon thy name, that stirreth up himself to take hold of thee: for thou hast hid thy face from us, and hast consumed us, because of our iniquities.

Lamentations 3:39. Wherefore doth a living man complain, a man for the punishment of his Sins?

Micah 7:9. I will bear the indignation of the LORD, because I have Sinned against him, until he plead my cause, and execute Judgment for me: he will bring me forth to the Light, and I shall behold his righteousness.

Should avoid sin.

Job 34:31-32. Surely it is meet to be said unto God, I have borne chastisement, I will not offend any more: That which I see not Teach thou me: if I have done iniquity, I will do no more.

Should trust in the goodness of God.

Job 13:15. Though he slay me, yet will I trust in him: but I will maintain mine own ways

before him.

Psalms 71:20. Thou, which hast shewed me great and sore troubles, shalt quicken me again, and shalt bring me up again from the depths of the earth.

2 Corinthians 1:9. But we had the sentence of Death in ourselves, that we should not trust in ourselves, but in God which raiseth the Dead:

Should turn and devote themselves to God.

Psalms 116:7-9. Return unto thy rest, O my soul; for the LORD hath dealt bountifully with thee. 8 For thou hast delivered my soul from Death, mine eyes from tears, and my feet from falling. I will walk before the LORD in the land of the living.

Jeremiah 50:3-4. For out of the north there cometh up a nation against her, which shall make her land desolate, and none shall dwell therein: they shall remove, they shall depart, both man and beast. In those days, and in that time, saith the LORD, the children of Israel shall come, they and the children of Judah together, going and weeping: they shall go, and seek the LORD their God.

Should keep the pious resolutions made during afflictions.

Psalms 66:13-15. I will go into thy house with Burnt Offerings: I will pay thee my vows, Which my lips have uttered, and my mouth hath spoken, when I was in trouble. I will offer unto thee burnt sacrifices of fatlings, with the incense of rams; I will offer bullocks with goats. Selah.

Should be frequent in prayer.

Psalms 50:15. And call upon me in the day of trouble: I will deliver thee, and thou shalt glorify me.

Psalms 55:16-17. As for me, I will call upon God; and the LORD shall save me. Evening, and morning, and at noon, will I pray, and cry aloud: and he shall hear my voice.

(See Affliction, Prayer under)

Should take encouragement from former mercies.

Psalms 27:9. Hide not thy face far from me; put not thy Servant away in Anger: thou hast

been my help; leave me not, neither forsake me, O God of my Salvation.

2 Corinthians 1:10. Who delivered us from so great a Death, and doth deliver: in whom we trust that he will yet deliver us;

Examples of Afflicted Saints.

Joseph,

Genesis 39:20-23. And Joseph's master took him, and put him into the prison, a place where the king's prisoners were bound: and he was there in the prison. But the LORD was with Joseph, and shewed him mercy, and gave him favour in the sight of the keeper of the prison. And the keeper of the prison committed to Joseph's hand all the prisoners that were in the prison; and whatsoever they did there, he was the doer of it. The keeper of the prison looked not to any thing that was under his hand; because the LORD was with him, and that which he did, the LORD made it to prosper.

Psalms 105:17-19. He sent a man before them, even Joseph, who was sold for a Servant: Whose feet they hurt with fetters: he was laid in iron: Until the time that his word came: the word of the LORD tried him.

Moses,

Hebrews 11:25. Choosing rather to suffer Affliction with the people of God, than to enjoy the pleasures of Sin for a season;

Eli,

1 Samuel 3:18. And Samuel told him every whit, and hid nothing from him. And he said, It is the LORD: let him do what seemeth him good.

Nehemiah,

Nehemiah 1:4. And it came to pass, when I heard these words, that I sat down and wept, and mourned certain days, and fasted, and prayed before the God of heaven,

Job,

Job 1:20-22. Then Job arose, and rent his mantle, and shaved his head, and fell down upon

the ground, and worshipped, And said, Naked came I out of my mother's womb, and naked shall I return thither: the LORD gave, and the LORD hath taken away; blessed be the name of the LORD. In all this Job Sinned not, nor charged God foolishly.

David,

2 Samuel 12:15-23. ¶ And Nathan departed unto his house. And the LORD struck the child that Uriah's wife bare unto David, and it was very sick. David therefore besought God for the child; and David fasted, and went in, and lay all night upon the earth. And the elders of his house arose, *and went* to him, to raise him up from the earth: but he would not, neither did he eat bread with them. And it came to pass on the seventh day, that the child died. And the servants of David feared to tell him that the child was dead: for they said, Behold, while the child was yet alive, we spake unto him, and he would not hearken unto our voice: how will he then vex himself, if we tell him that the child is dead? But when David saw that his servants whispered, David perceived that the child was dead: therefore David said unto his servants, Is the child dead? And they said, He is dead. Then David arose from the earth, and washed, and anointed *himself*, and changed his apparel, and came into the house of the LORD, and worshipped: then he came to his own house; and when he required, they set bread before him, and he did eat. Then said his servants unto him, What thing *is* this that thou hast done? thou didst fast and weep for the child, *while it was* alive; but when the child was dead, thou didst rise and eat bread. And he said, While the child was yet alive, I fasted and wept: for I said, Who can tell *whether* GOD will be gracious to me, that the child may live? But now he is dead, wherefore should I fast? can I bring him back again? I shall go to him, but he shall not return to me.

Paul,

Acts 20:22-24. And now, behold, I go bound in the spirit unto Jerusalem, not knowing the things that shall befall me there: Save that the Holy Ghost witnesseth in every city, saying that bonds and Afflictions abide me. But none of these things move me, neither count I my life dear unto myself, so that I might finish my course with joy, and the ministry, which I have received of the Lord Jesus, to testify the Gospel of the grace of God.

Acts 21:13. Then Paul answered, What mean ye to weep and to break mine heart? for I am ready not to be bound only, but also to die at Jerusalem for the name of the Lord Jesus.

Apostles.

1 Corinthians 4:13. Being defamed, we intreat: we are made as the filth of the world, and are the offscouring of all things unto this day.

2 Corinthians 6:4-10. But in all *things* approving ourselves as the ministers of God, in much patience, in afflictions, in necessities, in distresses, In stripes, in imprisonments, in tumults, in labours, in watchings, in fastings; By pureness, by knowledge, by longsuffering, by kindness, by the Holy Ghost, by love unfeigned, By the word of truth, by the power of God, by the armour of righteousness on the right hand and on the left, By honour and dishonour, by evil report and good report: as deceivers, and *yet* true; As unknown, and *yet* well known; as dying, and, behold, we live; as chastened, and not killed; As sorrowful, yet alway rejoicing; as poor, yet making many rich; as having nothing, and *yet* possessing all things.